

NEIL BERNARDO

Creative Leader & Design Technologist



PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Visionary Creative Leader and Design Technologist with over 15 years of agency experience elevating brand strategy into award-winning, cross-channel design systems. Specialized in fusing traditional design principles with AI-augmented workflows and emerging technologies to drive high-impact visual storytelling for enterprise and public-sector clients alike. Proven track record bridging high-level strategy with hands-on execution, mentoring and orchestrating cross-functional creative teams, and championing accessibility-first UX standards from concept through delivery.

TECHNICAL ARSENAL & AI PROFICIENCY

GENERATIVE AI & SYNTHESIS

Midjourney, Stable Diffusion, ChatGPT for Creative Strategy, Adobe Firefly (Beta Testing & Implementation), Prompt Engineering

DESIGN SYSTEMS & UX

Figma (Advanced Component Properties), Adobe Creative Cloud — Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, XD, After Effects

STRATEGIC LEADERSHIP

Workflow Auditing, Agile Project Management, WCAG Accessibility, Brand Stewardship

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Gordley Group

Sep 2025 – Present

Senior Designer

- Direct the end-to-end design process, from initial concept architecture to final asset delivery, to drive user engagement and brand scalability.
- Manage and mentor junior designers, providing actionable feedback to elevate the team's creative output and professional growth.
- Collaborate cross-functionally with product managers and developers to pitch concepts and articulate design rationales to stakeholders.
- Ensure absolute brand integrity and quality assurance across all digital and physical platforms for flawless production readiness.

Madden Media

Feb 2004 – Aug 2025

Art Director

Aug 2021 – Aug 2025

- Spearheaded award-winning marketing campaigns and materials for a diverse roster of public-sector clients, including dozens of tourism boards and municipalities.
- Pioneered UX modernization initiatives with a rigorous focus on WCAG accessibility standards to improve usability for diverse user groups.
- Developed systematized brand stewardship protocols that streamlined remote operations and fostered intradepartmental collaboration.

Creative Strategist

Jul 2015 – Aug 2021

- Led "Innovation Injection" initiatives by adopting emerging storytelling formats and interactive technologies.
- Translated complex brand objectives into compelling, human-centric creative concepts that bridged the gap between static design and digital engagement.

Creative Director, Emedia Division

Sep 2008 – Jul 2015

- Orchestrated a high-output team of award-winning digital media designers, establishing studio culture and rigorous quality standards.
- Engineered company-wide processes for online campaign components, significantly optimizing output speed while maintaining creative excellence.

Web Designer

Feb 2004 – Sep 2008

- Architected digital foundations and web experiences for high-profile international clients, including Electronic Arts and Coty Cosmetics.
- Designed comprehensive digital campaigns that established early industry standards for user engagement and digital storytelling.

ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP & AI CURRICULUM

Pima Community College

Sep 2021 – Present

Adjunct Faculty

- **AI Teaching and Learning Curriculum** — Developed and instructed a forward-looking curriculum focusing on the integration of Generative AI in design, covering prompt engineering techniques and the ethics of AI in creative fields.
- **Workflow Auditing** — Guided students in auditing design workflows to incorporate AI tools for increased efficiency and conceptual exploration.
- **Technical Instruction** — Delivered comprehensive instruction in Adobe Photoshop, InDesign, and Design Foundations, fostering technical excellence and conceptual rigor while utilizing Google Workspace for collaborative learning.
- **Curriculum Delivery** — Utilized D2L Brightspace to design and administer instructional materials for both virtual and in-person learning modalities.

EDUCATION

University of Arizona

Bachelor of Fine Arts in Visual Communication (Illustration) — *Cum Laude*

Pima Community College

Associate of Applied Science in Advertising Art